

Law No. 25 of 2001Mandatory Education 25 / 2001

Number of Articles: 13

☐ Stars icon indicate that some articles are amended

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Articles (1-13)

We, Hamad bin Khalifa Al Thani, Emir of the State of Qatar;
Having considered the Amended Provisional Constitution, and in particular Articles 23, 34, and 51 thereof;
Law No. 5 of 1970 specifying the Powers of Ministers and the Terms of Reference of the Ministries and other Government Bodies, as amended;
The proposal of the Minister of Education;
The draft law submitted by the Council of Ministers,
Having consulted the Shura Council;
Hereby promulgate the following law:

Articles

Article 1 (Amended By Law 25/2009)☐

In the implementation of the provisions of the present Law, the following terms and expressions shall have the following meaning assigned to each, unless the context otherwise requires:

The Council: Higher Board of Education

The Minister: The Minister of Education and Higher Education

Legal Guardian: The child's parent or any legal guardian appointed in lieu of the child's parent.

Article 2 (Amended By Law 25/2009)☐

Education shall be mandatory and free for all children from the beginning of the Primary stage of education to the end of the Secondary stage of education or when the child receiving such education becomes 18 years of age whichever is the sooner, and the Council shall provide for all educational requirements.

Article 3

The Legal Guardian of a child who turns six years of age at any time between the beginning of any school year or the last day of December of such year shall be obliged to enrol the child in mandatory education and ensure the child remains in mandatory education until he or she completes the Secondary stage of education or when he or she becomes 18 years of age whichever is the sooner

Article 4 (Amended By Law 25/2009)☐

The Higher Council of Health on or before the last day of January of each year shall issue lists of the names of children registered in census records one year before they become of legal age for mandatory education provided that these lists include the following data:

1. the child's name;

2. the name of the child's father and grandfather;
3. the last name if present;
4. Address and residential area.

The lists for the first year to which this Law applies should include the names of children from the age of five to the age of eighteen.

Article 5 (Amended By Law 25/2009) ☐

During the period of mandatory education the Legal Guardian of any child is obliged to notify the Council of any change of address of such child.

Article 6 (Amended By Law 25/2009) ☐

The Council shall enrol the children whose names appear on the lists referred to in Article 4 of this Law in the school nearest to their place of residence, and at least one month before the commencement of a child's mandatory education the Legal Guardian of such child shall provide to written information relating to the child giving notification of the name of the school that the child will attend, the date of the child's registration with such school, any required documents, and the date of the beginning of the mandatory period of education.

Article 7 (Amended By Law 25/2009) ☐

The administrative body of any school shall give written notice to the Legal Guardian of any child due to receive or receiving mandatory education in any of the following circumstances:

- a in the event that a child whose name appears on the list of children due to be enrolled in mandatory education has not been registered with the school allocated to such child within two weeks of the due date for registration;
 - b in the event that a child who has been registered with the school allocated to such child has not attended regularly and no acceptable reason has been provided to explain such absence;
 - c in the event that a child who has received the educational material relating to his or her forthcoming education and has not been registered with the school allocated to such child within one week of receipt of such educational material.
2. Within one week of observing that any child the subject of mandatory education continues to be absent from school without providing any acceptable reason for such continued absence such child shall be considered in violation of this Law the administrative body of any school shall notify the Council accordingly.

Article 8 (Amended By Law 25/2009) ☐

Any child who develops an illness or disability that prevents him or her from attending public or private schools is excused from mandatory education for the period of such illness or disability in accordance with a decision from the Minister based on a certificate of a Competent Medical Authority at the Higher Council of Health. This exemption also applies to any child suspended from school due to temporary circumstances. Exemption from mandatory school attendance shall cease when such illness, disability or temporary circumstance no longer affects the child.

Article 9 (Amended By Law 25/2009)

At his own expense, the Legal Guardian of a child may enrol the child in a school or institution at the same educational level of schools providing mandatory education provided that the Council is notified of the name of the school or institution at least one week before the beginning of the school year. The names of the private schools and institutions that are considered equivalent to the established study standards of mandatory education shall be determined by a decision from the Minister.

Article 10 (Amended By Law 25/2009)

In the event that a child reaches the legal age for the cessation of the mandatory stages of education without having successfully completed such stages of education, the child shall be granted a certificate stating the educational level attained and the Council shall enrol him or her in an appropriate educational establishment at the appropriate level.

Article 11 (Amended By Law 25/2009)

The Legal Guardian of any child who refrains from enrolling such child in mandatory education or in any other school or institution providing at least the same level of education as that of schools providing mandatory education without an acceptable excuse shall be liable to a fine of a minimum of Five Thousand Riyals (QAR 5,000) and a maximum of Ten Thousand Riyals (QAR 10,000). In the event of repeat violations of this legal obligation the fine applicable shall be a minimum of Ten Thousand Riyals (QAR 10,000) and a maximum of Twenty Thousand Riyals (QAR 20,000).

Article 12

The Minister shall make such decisions as are required to fulfil the provisions of this Law.

Article 13

All competent authorities, each within their respective areas of competence shall be liable to enforce this Law. This Law shall enter into force as from the date of its publication in the *Official Gazette*